

Modern World History

Middletown High School | Grade 12, Fall Semester 2026

Teacher: Ms. L. Brennan
Room: 221
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Course Description

A study of the modern world from industrialization to the Cold War, built on primary sources. Students learn to weigh evidence and to explain causes rather than list events.

Course Units

Weeks 1 to 3	Unit 1: The Industrial Revolution Mechanization, urban growth, labor conditions and the social movements that followed.
Weeks 4 to 6	Unit 2: World War I Long term causes were militarism, alliances, imperialism and nationalism, remembered as MAIN. The short term trigger was the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand in June 1914.
Weeks 7 to 9	Unit 3: The Interwar Years and the Great Depression The 1929 Wall Street Crash, mass unemployment, and the rise of extremist parties. The Treaty of Versailles fueled resentment in Germany.
Weeks 10 to 13	Unit 4: World War II Causes, the major theaters, the Holocaust, and the postwar settlement.
Weeks 14 to 16	Unit 5: The Cold War Containment, proxy conflicts, the arms race and the collapse of the Soviet bloc.

Key Dates This Semester

Sep 28	Source Analysis Essay due
Oct 23	Mid-Term Exam, covers Units 1 to 3
Nov 19	Research Project due
Dec 18	Final Exam

School wide dates

Sep 8	First day of classes
Oct 19 to Oct 23	Mid-term examination week
Nov 6	Parent teacher conferences
Nov 25 to Nov 27	Thanksgiving break, no classes
Dec 14 to Dec 18	Final examination week

Materials

Textbook (provided), notebook, folder for primary source packets.

Grading Policy

30 percent	Essays and source analysis
25 percent	Research project
10 percent	Quizzes
15 percent	Unit tests
20 percent	Final exam

A = 90 to 100 percent, B = 80 to 89, C = 70 to 79, D = 60 to 69, F = 59 and below.

Late and Make-Up Work

Work handed in late without an excused absence receives a maximum of 50 percent credit. With an excused absence, work is due within one week of returning. It is the student's responsibility to ask what was missed. Make-up tests are held on Thursdays after school and must be booked at least one day ahead.

Academic Honesty

All work submitted must be your own. Copying another student's work, or submitting text or code generated by someone or something else as your own, is treated as academic dishonesty and results in a zero for that assignment and a call home.

Extra Help

Extra help is available Tuesdays and Thursdays, 3:15 to 4:00 pm, in the room listed above.